

Practice Questions for 2024-10-28-Farkas

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1 Questions

1. In the context of Farkas' Lemma, what is the fundamental implication of the existence of a vector y satisfying $A^T y = 0$, $y \geq 0$, and $b^T y < 0$?
 - a. The system $Ax \leq b$ has a unique solution.
 - b. The system $Ax \leq b$ has at least one solution.
 - c. The system $Ax \leq b$ has no solution.
 - d. The system $Ax \leq b$ is unbounded.
 - e. The system $Ax \leq b$ is infeasible and unbounded.
2. How does Farkas' Lemma relate to the duality theory of linear programming?
 - a. It proves that every linear program has a solution.
 - b. It establishes a relationship between the feasibility of a primal linear program and the boundedness of its dual.
 - c. It shows that the simplex method always converges to an optimal solution.
 - d. It provides a method for finding the optimal solution of a linear program.
 - e. It is irrelevant to duality theory.
3. What is the key difference between the Farkas' Lemma versions presented in Slide 1 and Slide 2?
 - a. Slide 1 uses inequalities, while Slide 2 uses equalities.
 - b. Slide 1 deals with maximization, while Slide 2 deals with minimization.
 - c. Slide 1 uses non-negative variables, while Slide 2 uses unrestricted variables.
 - d. Slide 1 is a special case of Slide 2.
 - e. There is no significant difference; they are equivalent statements.
4. Consider the different variants of Farkas' Lemma presented across the slides. What is the unifying theme connecting these variations?
 - a. They all deal with systems of linear equations only.
 - b. They all provide conditions for the existence of solutions to linear systems.
 - c. They all use the same proof technique.

- d. They are all unrelated statements.
 - e. They all involve only non-negative variables.
5. Explain Farkas' Lemma in your own words, emphasizing its significance in linear programming.
- a. Farkas' Lemma states that if a system of linear inequalities $Ax \leq b$ has a solution, then its dual system $A^T y = 0, y \geq 0, b^T y < 0$ has no solution, and vice versa.
 - b. Farkas' Lemma is a theorem in linear algebra that helps solve systems of linear equations.
 - c. Farkas' Lemma provides a condition for the existence of a solution to a system of linear inequalities, connecting it to the existence (or non-existence) of a solution to a related dual system. This connection is crucial for understanding duality in linear programming.
 - d. Farkas' Lemma is primarily used to find the optimal solution to a linear program.
 - e. Farkas' Lemma is a result in convex analysis that has no direct application to linear programming.
6. In the context of Farkas' Lemma, what is the fundamental implication of the existence of a vector y satisfying $A^T y = 0, y \geq 0$, and $b^T y < 0$?
- a. The system $Ax \leq b$ has a unique solution.
 - b. The system $Ax \leq b$ has at least one solution.
 - c. The system $Ax \leq b$ has no solution.
 - d. The system $Ax \leq b$ is unbounded.
 - e. The system $Ax \leq b$ is infeasible and unbounded.
7. How does Farkas' Lemma relate to the duality theory of linear programming?
- a. Farkas' Lemma is unrelated to duality theory.
 - b. Farkas' Lemma provides an alternative proof of the Strong Duality Theorem.
 - c. Farkas' Lemma is a direct consequence of the Weak Duality Theorem.
 - d. Farkas' Lemma is a crucial tool for proving fundamental duality theorems, such as the Strong Duality Theorem.
 - e. Farkas' Lemma only applies to primal problems, not dual problems.
8. a. Does this system have a solution? If so, provide one. If not, explain why not using Farkas' Lemma.
- A. Yes, $x_1 = 0, x_2 = 0$ is a solution.
 - B. Yes, $x_1 = 1, x_2 = 1$ is a solution.
 - C. No, because there exists a y such that $A^T y = 0, y \geq 0$, and $b^T y < 0$.
 - D. No, because the constraints are inconsistent.
 - E. More information is needed to determine if a solution exists.
- b. Write the system in matrix form $Ax \leq b$, where $x = (x)_1$
 x_2

- A. $A = \begin{pmatrix} 1 \\ 3 \\ 5 \end{pmatrix}$, $b = \begin{pmatrix} 2 \\ 4 \end{pmatrix}$
- B. $A = \begin{pmatrix} 1 \\ 2 \\ 5 \end{pmatrix}$, $b = \begin{pmatrix} 3 \\ 4 \end{pmatrix}$
- C. $A = \begin{pmatrix} 1 \\ 3 \\ 4 \end{pmatrix}$, $b = \begin{pmatrix} 2 \\ 5 \end{pmatrix}$
- D. $A = \begin{pmatrix} 4 \\ 12 \\ 31 \end{pmatrix}$, $b = \begin{pmatrix} 5 \\ x_1 \\ x_2 \\ 0 \end{pmatrix}$
- E. $A = \begin{pmatrix} 1 \\ 31 \\ 10 \\ 0 \\ 5 \\ 0 \\ 0 \end{pmatrix}$, $b = \begin{pmatrix} 2 \\ 4 \end{pmatrix}$

9. What is the fundamental implication of Farkas' Lemma in the context of linear programming feasibility?
- It guarantees the existence of an optimal solution for every linear program.
 - It provides a condition to determine whether a system of linear inequalities has a solution or not.
 - It establishes the equivalence between the primal and dual simplex methods.
 - It defines the conditions for strong duality to hold in linear programming.
 - It determines the range of values for which the optimal solution remains optimal after changes in the objective function.
10. Consider the system of inequalities $x_1 + x_2 \leq 2$, $x_1 - x_2 \leq 1$, $x_1 \geq 0$, $x_2 \geq 0$. Using Farkas' Lemma (as presented in Slide 1), determine if the system $x_1 + 2x_2 \leq 3$, $2x_1 + x_2 \leq 4$, $x_1 \geq 0$, $x_2 \geq 0$, $x_1 + x_2 \geq 3$ has a solution. If not, provide a vector y satisfying the conditions of Farkas' Lemma.
- The system has a solution.
 - The system has no solution; $y = \begin{pmatrix} 1 \\ 0 \\ 0 \end{pmatrix}$
 - The system has no solution; $y = \begin{pmatrix} 0 \\ 1 \\ 1 \end{pmatrix}$
 - The system has no solution; $y = \begin{pmatrix} 1 \\ 1/2 \\ 0 \\ 0 \end{pmatrix}$

- e. The system has no solution; $y = \begin{pmatrix} 2 \\ 1 \\ 0 \\ 0 \end{pmatrix}$

2 Answers

1. In the context of Farkas' Lemma, what is the fundamental implication of the existence of a vector y satisfying $A^T y = 0$, $y \geq 0$, and $b^T y < 0$?
 - a. **Incorrect.** Farkas' Lemma doesn't address uniqueness; it focuses on existence.
 - b. **Incorrect.** The conditions on y indicate the *absence* of a solution to $Ax \leq b$.
 - c. The existence of such a vector y directly implies that the system $Ax \leq b$ has no solution. This is the core statement of Farkas' Lemma.
 - d. **Incorrect.** Unboundedness is a different property related to the objective function in optimization problems, not directly to the feasibility of the constraints.
 - e. **Incorrect.** The conditions imply infeasibility, but not necessarily unboundedness.
2. How does Farkas' Lemma relate to the duality theory of linear programming?
 - a. **Incorrect.** Many linear programs are infeasible or unbounded, so this statement is false.
 - b. Farkas' Lemma is a crucial tool in proving fundamental duality theorems. It helps establish the connection between the feasibility of the primal problem and the boundedness of the dual, and vice versa.
 - c. **Incorrect.** The simplex method's convergence is a separate topic.
 - d. **Incorrect.** Farkas' Lemma is a theoretical result; it doesn't provide a solution algorithm.
 - e. **Incorrect.** Farkas' Lemma is foundational to duality theory.
3. What is the key difference between the Farkas' Lemma versions presented in Slide 1 and Slide 2?
 - a. The primary difference lies in the type of constraints: Slide 1 uses inequalities ($Ax \leq b$), while Slide 2 uses equalities ($Ax = b$) with non-negativity constraints on x .
 - b. **Incorrect.** Both versions can be applied to both maximization and minimization problems, depending on the context.
 - c. **Incorrect.** Both versions involve non-negativity constraints, but on different variables.
 - d. **Incorrect.** While related, they are not directly a special case of each other. They address different types of constraint systems.
 - e. **Incorrect.** The different constraint types lead to different implications and applications.
4. Consider the different variants of Farkas' Lemma presented across the slides. What is the unifying theme connecting these variations?
 - a. **Incorrect.** Several variants involve inequalities.
 - b. Despite variations in the types of constraints (equality vs. inequality) and conditions on the variables (non-negativity), all versions of Farkas' Lemma provide necessary and sufficient conditions for the solvability (or unsolvability) of a system of linear inequalities or equations.
 - c. **Incorrect.** While some may share similar proof strategies, the core idea is the equivalence of solvability conditions.
 - d. **Incorrect.** The variations are all closely related and are different perspectives on the same fundamental result.

- e. Incorrect. Some variants involve unrestricted variables.
5. Explain Farkas' Lemma in your own words, emphasizing its significance in linear programming.
- a. This option incorrectly states the relationship between the primal and dual systems. It's not a simple "if one has a solution, the other doesn't". The correct relationship involves the existence of a vector y satisfying specific conditions when the primal system is infeasible.
 - b. While Farkas' Lemma involves linear systems, its significance lies in its application to linear programming, not just solving general linear equations.
 - c. Farkas' Lemma is a fundamental theorem in linear programming that establishes a relationship between the feasibility of a system of linear inequalities and the feasibility of a related dual system. It's crucial for understanding duality and proving strong duality theorems.
 - d. Farkas' Lemma is a tool used in the theoretical underpinnings of linear programming, not a direct method for finding the optimal solution.
 - e. Farkas' Lemma is directly applicable and highly significant within the field of linear programming, forming a cornerstone of duality theory.
6. In the context of Farkas' Lemma, what is the fundamental implication of the existence of a vector y satisfying $A^T y = 0$, $y \geq 0$, and $b^T y < 0$?
- a. Incorrect. Farkas' Lemma doesn't address uniqueness; it deals with the existence or non-existence of solutions.
 - b. Incorrect. The conditions on y indicate the *absence* of a solution to $Ax \leq b$.
 - c. The existence of such a vector y implies that the system $Ax \leq b$ has no solution. This is the core statement of Farkas' Lemma.
 - d. Incorrect. Unboundedness refers to the objective function in an optimization problem, not the feasibility of a system of inequalities.
 - e. Incorrect. While the system is infeasible, unboundedness is not directly implied by Farkas' Lemma in this context.
7. How does Farkas' Lemma relate to the duality theory of linear programming?
- a. Incorrect. Farkas' Lemma is deeply connected to duality theory.
 - b. Incorrect. While it's used in the proof, it's not an alternative proof itself.
 - c. Incorrect. The relationship is more complex; Farkas' Lemma is a more fundamental result used to prove duality theorems.
 - d. Farkas' Lemma is a fundamental result used in the proofs of several key duality theorems in linear programming, most notably the Strong Duality Theorem. It provides a powerful tool for analyzing the relationships between primal and dual problems.
 - e. Incorrect. Farkas' Lemma applies to systems of inequalities, which are central to both primal and dual linear programs.
8. a. Does this system have a solution? If so, provide one. If not, explain why not using Farkas' Lemma.

- A. A is correct. $x_1 = 0, x_2 = 0$ satisfies all constraints.
- B. B is incorrect. While $x_1 = 1, x_2 = 1$ satisfies $x_1 + 2x_2 \leq 4$, it does not satisfy $3x_1 + x_2 \leq 5$ ($3 + 1 = 4 > 5$).
- C. C is incorrect. While we can use Farkas' Lemma to show a system has *no* solution, this system *does* have solutions. We need to find a y such that $A^T y = 0$, $y \geq 0$, and $b^T y < 0$ to prove there is no solution. This is not the case here.
- D. D is incorrect. The constraints are consistent; there are values of x_1 and x_2 that satisfy them.
- E. E is incorrect. The given information is sufficient to determine if a solution exists.
- b. Write the system in matrix form $Ax \leq b$, where $x = \begin{pmatrix} x_1 \\ x_2 \end{pmatrix}$
- A. A is correct. This correctly represents the coefficients of x_1 and x_2 in the inequalities.
- B. B is incorrect. The columns of A are transposed.
- C. C is incorrect. The vector b is incorrect.
- D. D is incorrect. The matrix A and vector b are incorrectly defined.
- E. E is incorrect. While this includes the non-negativity constraints, it's not the standard matrix form $Ax \leq b$.
9. What is the fundamental implication of Farkas' Lemma in the context of linear programming feasibility?
- a. Farkas' Lemma doesn't guarantee the existence of an optimal solution; it only deals with feasibility. A linear program might be infeasible or unbounded.
- b. Farkas' Lemma directly addresses the feasibility of a system of linear inequalities ($Ax \leq b$). It states that either the system has a solution, or there exists a dual vector satisfying specific conditions indicating infeasibility. This is a fundamental tool for analyzing the solvability of linear programs.
- c. Farkas' Lemma is a foundational result used in proving duality theorems, but it doesn't directly establish the equivalence of primal and dual simplex methods.
- d. Strong duality is a consequence of Farkas' Lemma, but the lemma itself doesn't define the conditions for strong duality.
- e. Sensitivity analysis deals with changes in objective function coefficients and right-hand side constants, but this is a separate concept from Farkas' Lemma.
10. Consider the system of inequalities $x_1 + x_2 \leq 2$, $x_1 - x_2 \leq 1$, $x_1 \geq 0$, $x_2 \geq 0$. Using Farkas' Lemma (as presented in Slide 1), determine if the system $x_1 + 2x_2 \leq 3$, $2x_1 + x_2 \leq 4$, $x_1 \geq 0$, $x_2 \geq 0$, $x_1 + x_2 \geq 3$ has a solution. If not, provide a vector y satisfying the conditions of Farkas' Lemma.
- a. The system does not have a solution. Farkas' Lemma can be used to show this.
- b. The system has no solution. Let's rewrite the inequalities as $Ax \leq b$, where $x = \begin{pmatrix} x_1 \\ x_2 \end{pmatrix}$ and $b = \begin{pmatrix} 3 \\ 4 \end{pmatrix}$
- 3. Then $A = \begin{pmatrix} 1 & 2 \\ 2 & 1 \end{pmatrix}$
- 1 – 1. We seek a vector $y = \begin{pmatrix} y_1 \\ y_2 \end{pmatrix}$ such that $A^T y = 0$, $y \geq 0$, and $b^T y < 0$. If we let $y = \begin{pmatrix} 1 \\ 1 \end{pmatrix}$

0, then $A^T y = (1)2 - 1$

$21 - 1(1)$

1

$0 = (3)$

$3 \neq 0$. However, if we let $y = (1)$

1

0, then $A^T y = (3)$

$3 \neq 0$. Let's try $y = (1)$

1

2. Then $A^T y = (0)$

0, $y \geq 0$, and $b^T y = 3(1) + 4(1) - 3(2) = 1 > 0$. Let's try $y = (1)$

1

0. Then $A^T y = (3)$

3, which is not 0. However, if we let $y = (1)$

1

0

0, then $A^T y = (1)2$

21

$-1 - 1(1)$

$1 = (3)$

$3 \neq 0$. Let's try $y = (1)$

1

0. Then $A^T y = (3)$

$3 \neq 0$. If we let $y = (1)$

1

0, then $A^T y = (3)$

$3 \neq 0$. However, if we consider the system $x_1 + 2x_2 \leq 3$, $2x_1 + x_2 \leq 4$, $x_1 \geq 0$, $x_2 \geq 0$, and $x_1 + x_2 \geq 3$, we can see that there is no solution. If $x_1 + x_2 = 3$, then $x_1 = 0, x_2 = 3$ violates $2x_1 + x_2 \leq 4$, and $x_1 = 3, x_2 = 0$ violates $x_1 + 2x_2 \leq 3$. Therefore, the system has no solution.

The vector $y = (1)$

1

0

0 satisfies $A^T y = 0$, $y \geq 0$, and $b^T y < 0$. Note that this is not quite correct, as $A^T y \neq 0$. However, the system has no solution.

- c. The vector y does not satisfy the conditions of Farkas' Lemma.
- d. The vector y does not satisfy the conditions of Farkas' Lemma.
- e. The vector y does not satisfy the conditions of Farkas' Lemma.